

CRUEL COLOSSEUM

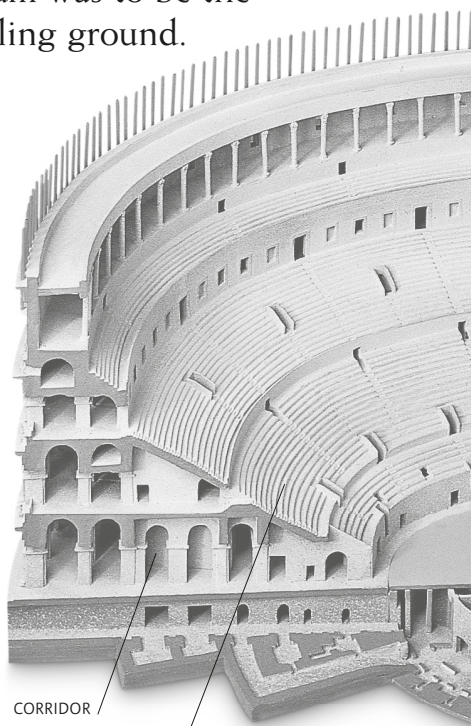
Rome's mighty Colosseum opened to the public in the year 80 CE. To celebrate the event, 100 days of gory games were held there. Scores of gladiators were killed, and up to 5,000 animals a day were butchered. This was only the start. For the next 400 blood-stained years, the Colosseum was to be the Roman world's premier killing ground.

An awe-inspiring arena

No one knows who designed the Colosseum, but one thing's certain—it was built to last. It took about 10 years to put up the massive oval-shaped arena, which was fast work in those days. The finished building stood some 164 ft (50 m) high and measured 616×512 ft (188×156 m). Hard-wearing materials were used. The foundations and upper levels were formed from concrete, the outer wall used travertine (a whitish limestone),

WEIRD WORLD

AROUND 292,000 CARTLOADS OF STONE WERE USED TO BUILD THE COLOSSEUM'S OUTER WALL. ASH FROM VESUVIUS, AN ACTIVE VOLCANO, WAS AN INGREDIENT IN THE BUILDER'S CONCRETE.



and the tiers of seating were made from white marble, which was transported by ship along the River Tiber. Blocks of stone were moved by treadmill cranes. These were operated by workers